

STAGE FIFTEEN • BUSINESS & ORGANIZATIONAL ACUMEN

FIRSTS

FAQ

Anticipated participant questions and suggested facilitator responses

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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Stage Fifteen • Business & Organizational Acumen

PURPOSE

These are the questions that come up most often across cohorts of Stage Fifteen, with a suggested facilitator response for each. Use these as a starting point, not a rigid script.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. What if I don't have much work experience to draw on for this stage?

A: School, part-time jobs, clubs, and teams all count as organizations with real structures, budgets (even informal ones), and decisions worth analyzing. The underlying dynamics this stage covers show up almost anywhere people work together toward a goal.

Q2. What if I genuinely don't have access to my organization's real financial documents (P&L, budget)?

A: That's completely normal, especially early in a career. Use a sample or publicly available document (many public companies post theirs) to practice the skill — the goal is learning to read and interpret one, not necessarily analyzing your own employer's real numbers.

Q3. How detailed does my business case (FIRST S14) need to be?

A: Detailed enough that a real decision-maker could act on it: a clear problem, a specific solution, genuine cost and benefit estimates (even rough ones), real risks, and a clear recommendation. It doesn't need to be polished or lengthy — substance matters more than length.

Q4. What if my competitive or market research turns up conflicting information?

A: That's genuinely common and worth noting explicitly in your analysis rather than picking whichever source is most convenient. Conflicting information is itself a useful finding — it often means the market or competitive picture is genuinely unsettled.

Q5. I found the Executive Perspective Exercise (S21) really difficult — is that normal?

A: Yes, genuinely. Thinking from a vantage point you haven't occupied yet is hard by design, and most participants find it harder than the earlier, more descriptive FIRSTS in this stage. Struggling with it is a sign you're doing it honestly, not a sign you're behind.

Q6. What if I can't actually implement the process improvement I propose in FIRST S23?

A: The in-session work is proposing a specific, well-reasoned fix — real implementation may depend on factors outside your control (approval, resources, timing). Document what you'd propose and why; genuine follow-through afterward, even partial, still counts.